

Weekly Status Update Template

Five minutes every Friday. This one email eliminates “just checking in” messages, surfaces blockers while they’re cheap to fix, and creates a paper trail that protects you if the project ever goes sideways.

The Template

Subject: [Project] — weekly update ([date])

Hi [Name],

✅ **Done this week** - [Item — link to it if viewable] - [Item]

🔧 **In progress** - [Item] — on track for [date]

➡ **Next week** - [Item]

⚠ **Needs your attention** - [Decision/asset needed] — **needed by [date]** to stay on schedule - (or: “Nothing — no action needed from you this week.”)

📊 **Status:** ● **On track** (or ● **At risk** — [why] / ● **Blocked** — [why]) **Budget/hours:** [X of Y hours used] (for hourly engagements)

[You]

The Rules

1. **Send it even when there’s nothing to report.** “Quiet week — waiting on [X], everything on schedule” still does its job. The update’s value is its *reliability*; the first Friday you skip is the day the client starts wondering.
2. **“Needs your attention” is the most important section.** Always include it, even when empty. When a project slips because the client sat on a decision, this section — with its dates — is your evidence, delivered politely, every single week.
3. **Never let ● flip straight to ●.** If there’s any risk, show ● with a reason *this week*. Clients forgive slipping timelines; they don’t forgive surprise.
4. **Keep it under 150 words.** The moment updates get long, you’ll dread writing them and the client will stop reading them. Bullets, not paragraphs.
5. **Same day, same time, every week.** Friday afternoon works for most. Consistency is what turns this from “an email” into “proof I hired a professional.”

Why This Is Worth 5 Minutes a Week

- **It kills anxiety pings.** Clients who hear from you every Friday don’t email you every Tuesday asking how it’s going.

- **It's pre-written dispute insurance.** Scope arguments, delay arguments, and “I didn't know about that” arguments all die against a weekly written record the client received and never objected to.
 - **It makes invoices painless.** By invoice day, the client has already read — week by week — exactly what they're paying for.
 - **It wins repeat work.** When clients describe working with you to others, “great communicator” is what gets you referred, and this template *is* that reputation, automated.
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